An orbit is continuous falling

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Explain a circular orbit with gravity and sideways motion.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Describe orbit as free fall rather than absent gravity.
2. Distinguish tangent velocity from inward force.
3. Connect circular speed to orbital radius.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

01 Warm-up: bring back an earlier idea

A projectile launches horizontally at 5 m/s from height 20 m. Use g=10 and no drag. Find flight time, range and final vertical velocity.

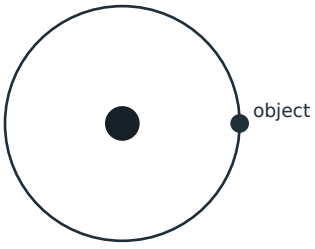
Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Worked example: explain the model

Reference: $GM/r^2 = v^2/r$; $v = \sqrt{(GM/r)}$.
Circular orbit outside a spherical body of mass M; r is orbital radius. Neglect atmosphere and other bodies.

Worked reasoning: A scale-model circular path has radius 4 m and speed 2 m/s. Its period is circumference/speed=2π×4/2=4π s. Gravity continuously changes the velocity direction.

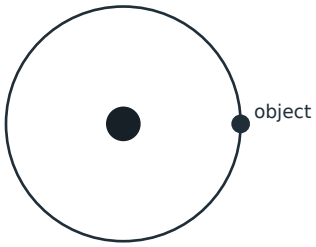
Your turn: Draw a quarter-orbit with tangent velocity arrows and inward gravitational arrows.



Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Read and interpret the model

Draw the path of an orbiting object and its velocity/force arrows. Explain how it can fall without immediately hitting the surface.

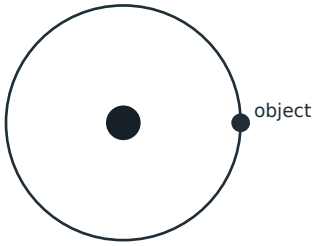


The center is the attracting body; the small dot on the circle is the orbiting object.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

04 Apply the physics

For a simulated planet GM=400 m^3/s^2 and circular radius 16 m, find orbital speed, period and acceleration. Label the radius and show velocity and inward acceleration on the circle.



Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

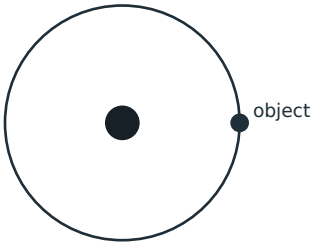
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Continue down each column.

05 Explain your reasoning

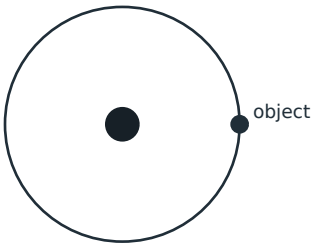
Why does a rocket not need to keep firing forward to remain in an ideal circular orbit?



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Review: connect an earlier idea

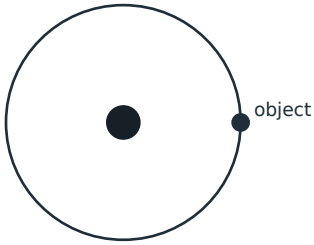
A 4 kg object moves at 6 m/s in an ideal circle under a force perpendicular to velocity. Explain which parts of velocity change and whether the force does work. Label velocity and inward acceleration on the circular model.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

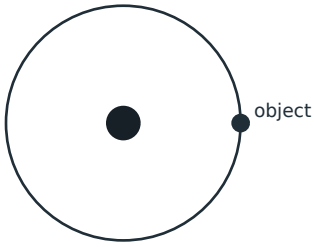
If circular orbital radius increases by factor 4 around same body, compare speed and period. Label the radius and show velocity and inward acceleration on the circle.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: test the model

Around one source, a circular orbit radius increases ninefold. Compare speed, period and gravitational acceleration without inserting a source mass. Label the radius and show velocity and inward acceleration on the circle.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3